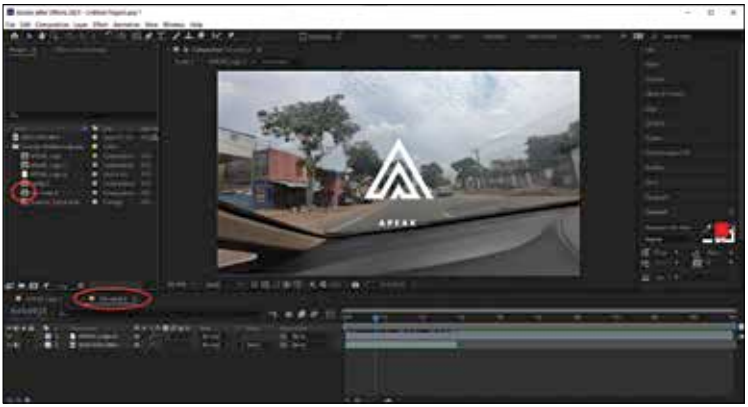
layer which encompasses all the previously selected layers.

In the timeline panel, you can see that the selected layers have now disappeared and there is just one substitute layer instead 'Pre-comp1'. This is also reflected in the project panel with addition of the same there.



The pre-compose dialog box which will be familiar to readers who have already used apps like Adobe Photoshop where you can group items together

UTILITY FACT: When you change the properties of a composition, for example, changing the time stretch factor as a whole, you can see that these changes are reflected across the composition uniformly to all its attributes or elements. The individual elements are not affected by this at the source though. When you create a pre-comp, you can see that a new tab is opened with the composition with all of its elements as individual layers

If you double click on a pre-composed layer, you will see that it opens as a new tab in the timeline panel with all of its elements on display. Making changes to the pre-composition will not affect the properties of the elements in any way and that is visible on this tab. On the other hand, any changes made to the elements in this tab will reflect on the final composition as they are linked. This is such a cool feature in After Effects. Just imagine how complex it would be if you had 10 sets of 10 different attributes and you just couldn't pre-compose them! Life saver!